

Here are some examples of topic sentences.

My new classmate is an interesting young woman.

My classmate is an energetic young man.

My new classmate is a friendly person.

Writer's Tip

Do NOT tell a specific fact about your classmate in your first sentence. For example, do not begin your paragraph with a sentence such as *My classmate is from China* or *My classmate is married*.

Step 3 Write several sentences telling about your classmate. Use your notes from the chart on page 3 to make sentences.

Step 4 End your paragraph with a concluding sentence that tells how you feel about your classmate.

I am happy to have Alex as my classmate.

I think Amy and I will become good friends.

I would like to play soccer with Tony after class some day.

Step 5 Check your paragraph.

- First, read your paragraph to the classmate whom you wrote about. Then ask him or her to complete Reader's Response 1A on page 190. Then decide together if you should make changes in your paragraph.
- Second, check your paragraph against Writer's Self-Check 1A on page 191.

Step 6 Write a neat final copy of your paragraph to hand in to your teacher. Your teacher may also ask you to hand in your prewriting and your other drafts.

PART 2 | Grammar and Capitalization

What Is a Sentence?

In the Organization section of this chapter, you learned that a paragraph is a group of sentences about one topic. How do you know what a sentence is? Here is a definition.

A **sentence** is a group of words that contains a subject and a verb and expresses a complete thought. A sentence begins with a capital letter and ends with a period.¹

¹A sentence may also end with a question mark or exclamation point, but in academic writing, most sentences end with a period.

These are sentences:

1. He is a student.
2. It is hot today.
3. He looks tired.
4. Are you hungry?
5. Who's there?
6. Hurry!
7. The man bought a new car.
8. Does your sister live with you?
9. Where did you buy that hat?
10. Don't be late.

These are not sentences:

11. Is very athletic. (*There is no subject.*)

In some languages, you can leave out a pronoun subject (*he, she, it, we, you, and they*) when the meaning is clear without it. English requires a subject in every sentence. (*Exception: See Command Sentences on page 12.*)

CORRECTED: **He** is very athletic.

12. The baby sleepy. (*There is no verb.*)

In some languages, you can leave out a verb like *is* or *are* when the meaning is clear without it. English requires a verb in every sentence.

CORRECTED: The baby **is** sleepy.

13. The man bought. (*This is not a complete thought. What did the man buy?*)

Many verbs in English require an object. (An object is a noun or pronoun that follows a verb.) Some of these verbs are *buy, give, have, like, love, need, own, place, put, spend, and want*.

OBJECT

CORRECTED: The man bought **a cup of coffee**.

14. When I finish my education. (*This is not a complete thought. What will happen when I finish my education?*)

A group of words that begins with *when, if, or because* (and others) is only half of a sentence. You must join it to another subject and verb to make a complete thought.

CORRECTED: When I finish my education, I will work for my uncle.

You will learn more about these half-sentences in Chapter 3.

Command Sentences

If a sentence gives a command or instruction, we understand that the subject is *you*, but we don't say or write *you*. The verb in a command sentence is always in the simple (dictionary) form—*stop*, *go*, *wait*, *be*, *eat*. To make a command negative, put *don't* in front of the verb.

Commands

(~~You~~) Be quiet.

(~~You~~) Wait for me!

(~~You~~) Speak slowly.

Negative Commands

(~~You~~) Don't eat so much!

(~~You~~) Don't forget to call home.

(~~You~~) Don't worry.

PRACTICE 2

Recognizing Sentences

- A. Which two sentences in examples 1–10 on page 11 are commands? Underline their verbs.
- B. Work with a partner.

Step 1 Read each group of words out loud.

Step 2 Decide which ones are complete sentences and which ones are not.

Step 3 Write *S* (for sentence) next to complete sentences and *NS* (for not a sentence) next to word groups that are not sentences.

Step 4 Explain why the *NS* word groups are not sentences.

1. NS Is very hot today. (There is no subject.)
2. S It is very hot today. (_____)
3. _____ My new classmate from Brazil.
(_____)
4. _____ He speaks three languages fluently.
(_____)
5. _____ Is very handsome. (_____)
6. _____ He wants to start his own business.
(_____)
7. _____ He isn't married. (_____)
8. _____ Enjoys many sports, especially baseball.
(_____)
9. _____ Don't sleep in class. (_____)
10. _____ The children hungry. (_____)
11. _____ They didn't like. (_____)
12. _____ They don't want. (_____)
13. _____ Go to bed! (_____)

Subjects, Verbs, and Objects

In English, the subject of a sentence is *always* expressed (except in commands).

The **subject** tells who or what did something. It is a noun or pronoun.

My roommate lost his keys.
(*Who lost his keys?—my roommate*)

The taxi hit the child.
(*What hit the child?—the taxi*)

Soccer and tennis are my favorite sports.
(*What are my favorite sports?—soccer and tennis*)

The **verb** usually tells an action. Sometimes a verb doesn't tell an action. Sometimes it just links the subject with the rest of the sentence.

Action verbs name an action, such as *hit, live, lose, speak, go, and come*.

The taxi **hit** the child.

My family **lives** in a two-bedroom apartment.

My roommate **lost** his keys.

Linking verbs link the subject with the rest of the sentence. Linking verbs do not have objects. The most common linking verbs are *be, become, look, feel, seem, smell, sound, and taste*.

'Soccer and tennis' **are** 'my favorite sports.'
 'I' **feel** 'today'.
 'The air' **smells** 'fresh and clean.'

The **object** receives the action of an action verb. It is a noun or pronoun.

To find an object, make a question by putting *what* after an action verb. (Note: This method for finding objects doesn't work with linking verbs because linking verbs do not have objects.)

The taxi hit **the child**.

(Hit what?—the child. The child is an object.)

My roommate lost **his keys**.

(Lost what?—his keys. His keys is an object.)

His girlfriend found **them**.

(Found what?—them. Them is an object.)

Not all sentences have objects.

My family lives in a two-bedroom apartment.

(Lives what?—not possible. This sentence has no object.)

The sun is shining today.

(Is shining what?—not possible. This sentence has no object.)

The fish didn't smell fresh.

(Didn't smell what?—not possible. This sentence has no object.)

Writer's Tip

Certain verbs **MUST** have objects. Some of these verbs are *buy, give, have, like, love, need, own, place, put, spend, and want*.

They need **some money**.

I don't want **it**.

PRACTICE 3

Subjects, Verbs, and Objects

Identify subjects, verbs, and objects in sentences.

Step 1 Underline the subjects with one line.

Step 2 Underline the verbs with two lines.

Step 3 Circle the objects.

Step 4 Write *S*, *V*, or *O* above each underlined or circled word.

1. My youngest brother is in high school. (There is no object.)

2. He watches TV and does homework at the same time.

3. He works at a shopping mall.

4. He likes his job but doesn't like his boss.

5. His job is easy and pays well.

6. This semester, he is taking extra classes.

7. He will go to college next year.

8. He speaks and understands English very well.
9. On weekends, he and his friends play soccer.
10. He doesn't have a girlfriend yet.

PRACTICE 4**Editing for
Subjects and
Verbs**

Step 1 Look for missing subjects and verbs.

Step 2 Add the missing words. (There may be more than one possible answer.)

Larry's Bad Habit

is
¹My friend Larry has a bad habit. ²He [^]never on time to anything. ³Arrives
 ten minutes late everywhere. ⁴Larry always an excuse. ⁵"I missed the
 bus." ⁶"My alarm clock didn't ring." ⁷"My watch stopped." ⁸"My mother
 telephoned me just as I was leaving." ⁹He uses each excuse at least
 twice a week. ¹⁰I know them all. ¹¹Whenever Larry rushes in—ten minutes
 late, of course—and starts to say, "Sorry I'm late, but I . . ." or "Sorry
 I'm late, but my . . ." or "Sorry I'm late, but my mother . . .," I can finish
 the sentence for him. ¹²Larry's bad habit not a problem for me any
 longer. ¹³If the movie at 7:00, I tell Larry it starts at 6:45. ¹⁴Then he early!

PRACTICE 5**Identifying and
Punctuating
Sentences**

Step 1 Decide where sentences begin and end. (There are 14 sentences.)

Step 2 Add a period at the end of each sentence, and change the first letter
 of each new sentence to a capital.

My Neighbors

a young couple from India lives next door to me the husband's name
 is Ajay the wife's name is Anjuli everyone calls her Anju they have a young
 son and are expecting their second child in a few weeks they hope to
 have a girl this time both Ajay and Anju have good jobs he is an executive
 in a computer company she is a computer programmer and works in our
 local hospital Anju is a wonderful cook she cooks mostly Indian food they
 sometimes invite neighbors on weekends for a potluck meal¹ we all bring
 something to share it is fun to live next door to Ajay and Anju.

¹potluck meal: meal to which everyone contributes a dish to share

Capitalization: In English, there are many rules for using capital letters. Here are six important ones.
Six Rules

Rules	Examples	
Capitalize:		
1. The first word in a sentence.	M y neighbor is a mechanic.	
2. The pronoun <i>I</i> .	My friends and I often study together.	
3. Names of people and their titles. BUT NOT a title without a name. <i>Exception:</i> A title without a name is sometimes capitalized if it refers to a specific person.	K ing A bdullah II P resident P utin P rofessor I ndiana J ones M r. and M rs. H omer S impson He's a king. Have you met your math professor? The P resident of the U nited S tates had dinner with the E mperor of J apan.	
4. Nationalities, languages, religions, and ethnic groups.	S wedish E nglish S panish F arsi M uslim	J ewish C hristian A sian H ispanic N ative A merican
5. Names of school courses with numbers. <i>Note:</i> Don't capitalize school subjects except names of nationalities, languages, religions, and college classes with numbers.	P sychology 101 history R ussian history math H istory 101 physics P hysics 352	
6. Specific places you could find on a map.	L ake T iticaca the N orth P ole S outh A merica A mazon R iver	E ngland F irst S treet T imes S quare N ew Y ork C ity

PRACTICE 6
Capitalization

Write your own examples for capitalization rules 3–6. Ask your teacher for help with spelling, or use a dictionary.

Rule 3

- a queen Queen Noor
- a president _____
- a doctor _____
- a mayor or governor _____

Rule 4

- a language _____
- a nationality _____
- a religion _____

Rule 5

- a school subject without a number _____
- a college class with a number _____

Rule 6

- a street _____
- a city or town _____
- a state _____
- a country _____
- a sea or an ocean _____
- an island _____
- a lake _____
- a river _____
- a park _____
- a square _____

PRACTICE 7**Editing for
Capitalization**

Nelson Mandela

Change the small letters to capital letters wherever necessary in the following paragraph.

N M
~~n~~elson ~~m~~andela

¹my name is nelson mandela, and i have had an unusual life. ²i have been both a prisoner and a president in my country. ³i was born in 1918 in a small village in south africa. ⁴my father, henry mandela, was the chief of our tribe.¹ ⁵as a child, i took care of the family's cattle and goats. ⁶when i grew up, i decided to become a lawyer. ⁷this seemed to be a good way to help my people. ⁸after i became a lawyer, i became the leader of a group of young africans who wanted to change the system of discrimination² in our country. ⁹because of my political activities, i went to prison for twenty-seven years. ¹⁰the prison was on a cold, windy island in the atlantic ocean. ¹¹however, the world didn't forget about me. ¹²i received important visitors, awards, and university degrees from all over the world. ¹³i also learned afrikaans, which is the language of white south africans. ¹⁴of course, i also speak english and xhosa, which is the language of my tribe. ¹⁵in 1990, i was set free. ¹⁶i became the president of south africa in 1994. ¹⁷during my time in office, i tried to bring peace, democracy, and prosperity to all of my country's people. ¹⁸now i am retired.

**Journal
Writing**

A journal is a notebook in which you write about your life and your thoughts. Each time you write in your journal, you make a **journal entry**.

Your teacher will not grade your journal, so journal writing is a good way to practice new skills without worrying about a grade. Your teacher will read each entry and make comments. He or she may ask questions for you to answer in your next entry. You can also write questions to your teacher in your journal. A journal can be like a conversation.

¹**tribe:** group of people who live in the same area and have the same customs, beliefs, and leader

²**discrimination:** treating one group of people differently from another in an unfair way